# ENGLISH

**This section contains 22 questions.**
The time allotted is 20 minutes.

The following section contains three types of questions: Sentence Completion, Restatement and Reading Comprehension. Each question is followed by four possible responses. Choose the response **which best answers the question** and mark its number in the appropriate place on the answer sheet.

*Sentence Completions* (Questions 1-8)
This part consists of sentences with a word or words missing in each. For each question, choose the answer **which best completes the sentence**.

**1.** The magnificent palace at Fontainebleau is the crowning ____ of French Renaissance architecture.

(1) glory
(2) desire
(3) moral
(4) relief

---

**2.** A well-worded ____ can make an average photograph memorable.

(1) facade
(2) garment
(3) caption
(4) martyr

---

**3.** Within weeks of the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand, the chief European powers were ____ into World War I.

(1) broken
(2) sewn
(3) worn
(4) drawn

---

**4.** Rather than ____ Western European musical styles, nineteenth-century composer Modest Petrovich Mussorgsky created distinctively Russian forms of music.

(1) imitate
(2) neutralise
(3) postpone
(4) decorate

---

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

**5.** Seals use their fins and flippers to ____ themselves through the water.

(1) propel
(2) fracture
(3) extort
(4) behold

---

**6.** The Center for American War Letters is an archive of wartime ____ from every conflict in American history.

(1) correspondence
(2) affluence
(3) proficiency
(4) expansion

---

**7.** Souvenirs are ____ reminders of important people, places, or events.

(1) retractable
(2) tangible
(3) susceptible
(4) commendable

---

**8.** Some authors prefer to remain anonymous, publishing their works under ____ names.

(1) enchanted
(2) overruled
(3) assumed
(4) invested

---

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

*Restatements* (Questions 9-12)
This part consists of several sentences, each followed by four possible ways of restating the main idea of that sentence in different words. For each question, choose the one restatement **which best expresses the meaning of the original sentence**.

**9.** The pace of construction in Tokyo is dizzying.

(1) Tokyo is one of the busiest cities in the world.
(2) Tokyo is being built up extremely rapidly.
(3) Tokyo is at the forefront of innovative construction techniques.
(4) Tokyo is encouraging the development of new industries.

---

**10.** Age-related bias in the workplace is regrettably more prevalent than ever.

(1) Increasingly, employers are being pressured to hire people of all ages.
(2) Unfortunately, the practice of discriminating against workers on the basis of age is more widespread than it once was.
(3) Surprisingly, the most common form of prejudice in the workplace is age related.
(4) As people age, they generally have more difficulty finding work.

---

**11.** Noah Webster's widely lauded American English dictionaries represent but a fraction of his scholarly corpus.

(1) Webster's groundbreaking American English dictionaries were but the first in a long line of highly regarded scholarly works.
(2) Webster had a vast number of other scholarly accomplishments to his name besides his celebrated American English dictionaries.
(3) The impact of Webster's American English dictionaries was overshadowed by his far-reaching influence in other scholarly fields.
(4) Faced with the immense task of preparing his American English dictionaries, Webster was compelled to set aside his many other scholarly projects.

---

**12.** Having joined NATO in March 2004, the Baltic states promptly acceded to the European Union (EU), a sequence of events that infuriated Russian President Vladimir Putin.

(1) The Baltic states' relationship with Putin, already strained when they joined the EU, completely collapsed when they applied to NATO in 2004.
(2) The Baltic states were hesitant to become part of NATO and the EU in 2004, knowing that this would provoke Putin.
(3) In defiance of Putin's protestations, the Baltic states initiated membership negotiations with the EU shortly after they had been accepted into NATO in 2004.
(4) Putin was outraged when the Baltic states were admitted to the EU on the heels of becoming members of NATO in 2004.

---

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

## *Reading Comprehension*

This part consists of two passages, each followed by several related questions. For each question, **choose the most appropriate answer based on the text**.

*Text I* (Questions 13-17)

Ever since the 1930s, when families across the U.S. tuned in to *Uncle Jim's Question Bee* on the radio, game shows have been part of American popular culture. Particularly after *Truth or Consequences*, another radio game show, was adapted for television in 1950, the genre became a hit. Over the years, game shows have become standard television fare, and a number of formats have emerged. Chief among these are trivia quizzes, relationship or dating games, and tests of endurance. Today, game shows and their celebrity hosts are permanent features of television culture. Almost every day of the week, they are broadcast at peak viewing times.

The success of such shows is largely dependent on the eagerness of ordinary people to appear on TV. The chance to win money and prizes offsets the potential for failure or embarrassment in front of millions of viewers. An additional incentive for contestants is the fantasy of being catapulted to fame and fortune themselves: several well-known actors and comedians got their start on game shows. No wonder so many people vie for the "privilege" of being a contestant.

Ultimately, however, it is audience involvement – whether in the TV studio or from the comfort of one's living room – that differentiates game shows from other programs produced for television. Indeed, the game show's unending public appeal can be attributed to the play-along aspect. Many viewers actively participate: they talk to the TV screen, advise the contestants, call out answers to questions, and share in the tension and excitement of the actual participants.

## *Questions*

**13.** It can be inferred from the first paragraph that *Uncle Jim's Question Bee* was -

(1) broadcast on both radio and television
(2) later called *Truth or Consequences*
(3) only broadcast until 1950
(4) the first popular game show in the U.S.

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

**14.** It can be inferred from the first paragraph that a contestant on a game show might be asked to do any of the following except -

(1) quit his or her job
(2) name the capital of Peru
(3) run up the stairs of a tall building
(4) describe the kind of person he or she would like to marry

---

**15.** The main purpose of the second paragraph is to discuss -

(1) the disadvantages of being on a game show
(2) different kinds of people who participate in game shows
(3) why people want to be on game shows
(4) people made famous by appearing on game shows

---

**16.** According to the second paragraph, contestants on game shows -

(1) do not like attention
(2) can win prizes and money
(3) are funny as well as smart
(4) are chosen from the audience

---

**17.** According to the last paragraph, who plays along (line 18) with a game show?

(1) the contestant
(2) the viewers at home
(3) the host
(4) the producers

---

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

*Text II* (Questions 18-22)

In 1905, a massive diamond was discovered at the Premier Mine in Cullinan, a town in the British Empire's Transvaal Colony in South Africa. At 3,106 carats – the weight and size of an average human heart – it was and still is the largest gem-quality rough diamond ever found. The Cullinan, as the diamond was named, was put on display in Johannesburg and later that year was sent to the Premier Mine Company's London offices to be sold. With the eyes of the world watching in fascination, the diamond was given an appropriately grand sendoff by ship, accompanied by armed guards. Unbeknownst to most, the Cullinan had actually been posted to London in an inconspicuous parcel. It arrived safely, but no buyer could be found. Eventually, the Transvaal government purchased the stone and presented it to King Edward VII on the occasion of his 66th birthday.

After due deliberation, the King decided to entrust the formidable task of cutting and polishing the Cullinan to master craftsman Joseph Asscher of Amsterdam. The diamond would thus need to make another journey. With much fanfare and publicity, a sealed box ostensibly containing the Cullinan was placed on a Royal Navy ship that set sail for the Netherlands. Meanwhile, Joseph's brother Abraham was aboard a different ship bound for the same destination. In one of the pockets of his winter coat was the diamond that was the talk of the world.

Joseph Asscher spent six months studying the diamond in minute detail. According to his calculations, the Cullinan could be cleaved into two pieces, and then into smaller stones. But diamond cutting is a delicate business – one tiny error could shatter the precious stone. Asscher spent a full month meticulously carving a one-centimetre-deep groove in the stone. On February 10, 1908, he was finally ready to make the cut. Reporters and other spectators crowded into his workshop, keen to witness the world's greatest diamond cutter either successfully split the world's largest rough diamond or fail and reduce it to fragments.

Asscher was under tremendous pressure when the moment arrived. He carefully wedged a splitting knife into the groove and then struck it forcefully with a hammer. A cracking sound rang out – not that of the Cullinan dividing but that of the knife breaking, confirming that diamond is indeed the hardest substance on earth. Four days later, equipped with sturdier tools, Asscher finally split the Cullinan in two. Over the next eight months, he and his team of expert cutters and polishers created nine large jewels for the King and his family. Ninety-six smaller stones from the Cullinan were retained by the Asscher Diamond Company as payment for services rendered.

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

*Questions*

**18.** The first paragraph does not state that the Cullinan diamond -

(1) is the biggest gem-quality rough diamond ever found
(2) was bought by the Premier Mine Company
(3) was exhibited to the public before being sent to London
(4) was as large as a human heart

---

**19.** According to the text, the Cullinan was brought to ____ by ____.

(1) London ; King Edward VII
(2) Johannesburg ; the postal service
(3) the Transvaal Colony ; the Premier Mining Company
(4) the Netherlands ; Abraham Asscher

---

**20.** "After due … formidable task" (line 12) could best be replaced by -

(1) Having no other option, the King was forced to give the responsibility
(2) On the advice of experts, the King granted the enormous honour
(3) The King, who could not find a qualified Englishman, agreed to give the job
(4) The King, after careful consideration, assigned the challenging job

---

**21.** It can be inferred from the text that the real reason that both of the Cullinan's sendoffs were so grand was -

(1) to attract potential buyers
(2) to honour the British Empire
(3) to satisfy the public's interest
(4) to reduce the chances of its being stolen

---

**22.** The main purpose of the last two paragraphs is to -

(1) describe the process of cutting the Cullinan
(2) present Asscher's plan for cutting the diamond
(3) explain why Asscher's first attempt at cutting the diamond failed
(4) discuss the risks that were involved in cutting the Cullinan

---

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.